JavaScript. Relax if your JavaScript is still rusty at this point; just follow along and look at the syntax.

1.5.1. Designing new syntax

To arrive at CoffeeScript syntax, start with a small JavaScript program and see what can be removed without changing the meaning of the program. An uninteresting program serves this purpose well, so consider a function to square two numbers:

```
var square = function (x) {
  return x * x;
};
```

How much of the syntax is necessary? For a start, you can remove the semicolons:

```
var square = function (x) {
  return x * x
}
```

You can also remove the C-inspired curly braces:

```
var square = function (x)
  return x * x
```

You can also remove the `var` statement by making it implicit instead of explicit:

```
square = function (x)
  return x * x
```

The same applies to the `return` statement. Remove that also:

```
square = function (x)
  x * x
```

Finally, the `function` keyword is important and used frequently, but suppose you replace it with something that doesn’t take so long to read or type: